AcneLens — Recommendation Rules for Expert Review

Generated from the app's own rule code. Rate the appropriateness of each rule (1 = strongly disagree … 5 = strongly agree) and note any change you would recommend. Ingredients only — no brands are ever suggested.

Table C1 — Base rules (AI result × skin type), shown for a resilient user not on any treatment

Rule	AI result	Skin type	Cleanser	Target treatment	Moisturizer	Appropriate?
R-001	Non-Inflammatory	Oily	Salicylic Acid Wash 2% CLN-01	Adapalene 0.1% TGT-02	Oil-Free Gel Moisturizer MST-01	1 2 3 4 5
R-002	Non-Inflammatory	Dry	Hydrating Cream Cleanser CLN-02	Salicylic Acid 0.5–2% TGT-03	Ceramide-Rich Cream MST-02	1 2 3 4 5
R-003	Non-Inflammatory	Combination	Salicylic Acid Wash 2% CLN-01	Adapalene 0.1% TGT-02	Lightweight Lotion MST-03	1 2 3 4 5
R-004	Non-Inflammatory	Normal	Gentle Fragrance-Free Cleanser CLN-03	Adapalene 0.1% TGT-02	Lightweight Lotion MST-03	1 2 3 4 5
R-005	Inflammatory	Oily	Salicylic Acid Wash 2% CLN-01	Benzoyl Peroxide 2.5% TGT-01	Oil-Free Gel Moisturizer MST-01	1 2 3 4 5
R-006	Inflammatory	Dry	Hydrating Cream Cleanser CLN-02	Benzoyl Peroxide 2.5% TGT-01	Ceramide-Rich Cream MST-02	1 2 3 4 5
R-007	Inflammatory	Combination	Salicylic Acid Wash 2% CLN-01	Benzoyl Peroxide 2.5% TGT-01	Lightweight Lotion MST-03	1 2 3 4 5
R-008	Inflammatory	Normal	Gentle Fragrance-Free Cleanser CLN-03	Benzoyl Peroxide 2.5% TGT-01	Lightweight Lotion MST-03	1 2 3 4 5
R-009	Clear Skin	Oily	Gentle Fragrance-Free Cleanser CLN-03	Niacinamide (antioxidant) — maintenance TGT-05	Oil-Free Gel Moisturizer MST-01	1 2 3 4 5
R-010	Clear Skin	Dry	Gentle Fragrance-Free Cleanser CLN-03	Niacinamide (antioxidant) — maintenance TGT-05	Ceramide-Rich Cream MST-02	1 2 3 4 5
R-011	Clear Skin	Combination	Gentle Fragrance-Free Cleanser CLN-03	Niacinamide (antioxidant) — maintenance TGT-05	Lightweight Lotion MST-03	1 2 3 4 5
R-012	Clear Skin	Normal	Gentle Fragrance-Free Cleanser CLN-03	Niacinamide (antioxidant) — maintenance TGT-05	Lightweight Lotion MST-03	1 2 3 4 5

Table C2 — Modifiers, fallback and referral notices (applied on top of the base rule)

Rule	Effect	Appropriate?
M-01	Highly sensitive skin: gentle cleanser, azelaic acid instead of stronger actives, barrier-repair moisturizer. Benzoyl peroxide and adapalene are not suggested.	1 2 3 4 5

M-02	Already using a strong acne treatment: no new active is added, to avoid irritation from stacking actives. Cleanser and moisturizer still apply.	1 2 3 4 5
F-00	Universal fallback: gentle cleanser + barrier cream, no active.	1 2 3 4 5
A-01	Inflammatory result: advise seeing a dermatologist (display only — does not change the routine).	1 2 3 4 5
A-02	Self-reported cysts or nodules: advise seeing a dermatologist (display only — does not change the routine).	1 2 3 4 5

Order: base rule → M-01 (sensitivity) → M-02 (current treatment; applied last, so it wins: no new active is added even if M-01 suggested azelaic acid). A-01/A-02 only display advice; they never change ingredients. Together these cover all 48 combinations (3 AI results × 4 skin types × 2 sensitivity levels × 2 treatment states).

Table B — Ingredients and evidence

ID	Ingredient	Vehicle	What it does	Evidence
TGT-01	Benzoyl Peroxide 2.5%	Gel / Lotion	Kills acne-causing bacteria (bactericidal).	AAD 2024 — strong recommendation
TGT-02	Adapalene 0.1%	Gel	Topical retinoid: unclogs pores (comedolytic) and calms inflammation.	AAD 2024 — strong recommendation (topical retinoids)
TGT-03	Salicylic Acid 0.5–2%	Liquid / Gel	Loosens dead skin inside pores (comedolytic).	AAD 2024 — conditional recommendation (low certainty of evidence)
TGT-04	Azelaic Acid 15–20%	Gel / Cream	Unclogs pores, fights bacteria, calms inflammation; also fades dark marks left by acne.	AAD 2024 — conditional recommendation; noted benefit for sensitive skin and darker skin tones
TGT-05	Niacinamide (antioxidant) — maintenance	Serum / Lotion	General preventive care to keep skin balanced.	Not an AAD treatment recommendation; general dermatologic maintenance practice
CLN-01	Salicylic Acid Wash 2%	Foaming Gel	Cleanses while helping keep pores clear.	International expert consensus on dermocosmetics in acne (JEADV 2024)
CLN-02	Hydrating Cream Cleanser	Cream / Lotion	Cleanses without stripping the skin's moisture.	International expert consensus on dermocosmetics in acne (JEADV 2024)
CLN-03	Gentle Fragrance-Free Cleanser	Foam / Liquid	Low-irritation cleansing.	International expert consensus on dermocosmetics in acne (JEADV 2024)
MST-01	Oil-Free Gel Moisturizer	Gel	Light hydration that won't clog pores (non-comedogenic).	International expert consensus on dermocosmetics in acne (JEADV 2024)
MST-02	Ceramide-Rich Cream	Rich Cream	Repairs the skin barrier and hydrates deeply.	International expert consensus on dermocosmetics in acne (JEADV 2024)
MST-03	Lightweight Lotion	Lotion	Balanced hydration for mixed or normal skin.	International expert consensus on dermocosmetics in acne (JEADV 2024)
MST-04	Fragrance-Free Barrier Repair Cream	Rich Cream	Repairs the barrier with the fewest possible irritants.	International expert consensus on dermocosmetics in acne (JEADV 2024)

Reynolds RV, et al. Guidelines of care for the management of acne vulgaris. J Am Acad Dermatol. 2024;90(5):1006.e1–1006.e30. doi:10.1016/j.jaad.2023.12.017
International Expert Consensus Recommendations for the Use of Dermocosmetics in Acne. J Eur Acad Dermatol Venereol. 2024;39(5):952–966. doi:10.1111/jdv.20145

Comments / suggested changes